

FOR GROKATHON PARTICIPANTS

Build something the public can actually trust

Inspirational guidance for using **Grok Tutor & The Hive**
to develop product ideas for real-world **civic and public** use

Companion pack · 2026-08-07 · Share freely with your team
Integrity-first · Educational lab · No overclaims

*“The public does not need another demo that looks smart.
They need tools that stay honest when the data is incomplete.”*

Spirit of this gift. This is **inspirational guidance** and an educational codebase—not a winning formula, not an official Grokathon rulebook, and not a promise of prizes, accreditation, or production authority. Take what helps. Leave what does not. Build something you would defend in daylight.

1. Why this matters in a Grokathon

Hackathons reward speed. Civic and public products reward **trust**. The teams that stand out are not always the ones with the flashiest UI—they are the ones who can explain **what they know, what they are guessing, and who decides** when it matters.

Grok Tutor was built as a craft-learning app with a spatial home called **The Hive**. You can use it as a **thinking gym** while you invent: practice teaching a flow, stress-test a multi-role workflow, and refuse the shortcuts that look polished but fail real people.

What “winning” can mean beyond the scoreboard

- A product idea that a non-expert can understand in 60 seconds.
- A claim surface that never pretends incomplete data is finished truth.
- A clear human final call—software assists; people remain accountable.
- A demo that stays free of private data and real place-name leakage.
- A path from weekend prototype to something you could keep building with integrity.

2. North-star principles (print this page)

Principle	In the lab	In your Grokathon build
Tri-state claims	Tag Evidence / Inference / Assumption in lessons and scenarios.	Every public-facing claim is labeled or scoped—or removed.
Human final call	Orchestration and tools support judgment; they do not replace it.	Name the decision owner before you automate anything consequential.
Clean share	Samples avoid real PII and real municipality names.	Your pitch deck and demo data stay scrubbed if screenshots go public.
Honest incomplete	Soft failure and missing inputs stay visible.	Degraded mode tells the truth instead of inventing green checks.
No overclaim	Help/Credits state educational limits.	Never market as license, accreditation, legal/medical authority, or official government system.

Attribution for integrity lineage (conceptual spark, not embedded product software): see in-app **/credits**, **NOTICE**, and **README**—including CAI-OS notices as specified by their creator.

3. The Hive as your weekend design studio

Do not treat The Hive as wallpaper. Each shape is a **room that forces a better product question**. Open a shape, run a short orchestration, and ask: would this still hold if a journalist, a resident, and an auditor all watched?

Open this	Ask this product question
Mission spine	What is the single public mission we will not trade for convenience?
Integrity triangle	What is known, inferred, and still undecided—before we ship UI?
Four-agent field	Which roles must collaborate, and where do incentives conflict?

Open this	Ask this product question
Claim diamond	Can every sentence on the product surface be backed, scoped, or withdrawn?
Sense / deep modes	What external signals are allowed—and what stays quarantined until gated?

Local demo links (after `npm run dev` on port **8085**):

<http://127.0.0.1:8085/?orch=1&shape=spine>

<http://127.0.0.1:8085/?orch=1&shape=integrity-triangle>

<http://127.0.0.1:8085/?orch=1&shape=four-agent>

4. A 24-hour Grokathon path (inspired, not mandatory)

Use this if you want structure. Adapt freely. The point is momentum **with** integrity—not bureaucracy.

1

Hour 0–1 · Frame a public problem

One sentence. No real private names. No real place names in sample copy. Who is helped? Who could be harmed?

2

Hour 1–2 · Pick a Hive shape and stress the idea

Integrity for contested truth. Four-agent for multi-role ops. Spine for mission clarity. Run Play once and note friction.

3

Hour 2–4 · Walk a sample lesson or desk

Use Learn / Samples / a related industry pack. Where would a first-time user freeze? That is your UX risk list.

4

Hour 4–8 · Build the thinnest honest slice

One flow, three claims tagged E/I/A, one human final call, one degraded-state message. Prefer truth over feature count.

5

Hour 8–12 · OPSEC pass before you present

Strip PII. Strip secrets. Prefer product HTTP demos. Read Help/Credits limits out loud as a team.

6

Before judging · Tell the integrity story

Show what you refused to automate. Show what stays incomplete. Show who decides. That is civic maturity.

5. Civic idea seeds (sparks only)

These are **starting sparks** for brainstorming—not assigned challenges, not endorsed projects, and not permission to use restricted data. Keep demos generic and lawful.

Spark	Why it is hard (good)	Integrity hook
Public-records literacy coach	People drown in process language.	Teach method, not harvesting private lives.
Permit pathway explainer	Steps feel opaque to newcomers.	Educational map only—never fake an official decision.
Field notes trainer for infrastructure roles	Safety and documentation quality matter.	Not a substitute for licensed inspection.
Oversight briefing builder	Leaders need short, honest packets.	Tri-state claims on every assertion.
Civic onboarding companion	First-week confusion burns people out.	Dignity-first language; no manipulation patterns.

Spark	Why it is hard (good)	Integrity hook
Claims hygiene checklist for public dashboards	Pretty charts hide uncertainty.	Evidence vs inference visible in the UI.

6. Open the lab (share pack)

From the extracted share folder:

```
npm install
cp .env.example .env
npm run dev
```

Open <http://127.0.0.1:8085/>

Optional live model: set server-side XAI_API_KEY only in .env (never in the browser, never in git).

Without a key, offline educational replies still teach.

Quick verify before you demo to others

```
npm run test:shape · npm run audit:public · npm run test:e2e50
```

Tour: Home/Hive → Help (limits) → Credits (attribution) → one Sample/Learn path → one Tools/skill lens → optional Plan Lab (educational CAD only).

7. Grokathon pitch canvas (one page)

Fill this before you present. Keep every field free of private data and real place names in samples.

Field	Your answer
Public mission (one sentence)	
Who is helped / who could be harmed	
The thinnest honest slice we built	
Claims on screen (tag E / I / A)	
Human final call (role + moment)	
What we refused to automate	
How we show incomplete / offline state	
OPSEC rules we enforced in the demo	
What we will verify after the weekend	

8. Go build something defensible

The best civic prototypes from a weekend are not the ones that claim the most. They are the ones that **earn the right to be continued**—clear mission, honest claims, human accountability, and respect for the public's data and attention.

Use Grok Tutor as a sparring partner for that standard. Remix. Teach. Stress-test. Then ship only what you can stand behind.

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